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Wellington & District
LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Euchareena, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbon and Yeoval districts.

Established August, 2021
 No. 239

THURSDAY, JULY 2 2026

ISSN 2653-2026

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WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

Racing at
 Wellington
SUNDAY
 July 5
 Full TAB -7-race card
 Bring the Family!!

Wellington Eisteddfod
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 volunteers -
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Lions news,
 awards and
 fundraisers -
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Buckinbah
 to Yeoval
 What's in a
 name? - P 5

Yeoval united at long last

Cabonne Council gains complete control of what was a (local government) boundary divide in major milestone for the whole community who have advocated for more than 140 years.

MEDIA RELEASE - Major Milestone as North Yeoval Joins Cabonne
 IT'S TAKEN 140 years, but Yeoval is no longer a divided town controlled by two masters.

As of yesterday, North Yeoval is now incorporated to Cabonne Council.

The boundary adjustment from Dubbo Regional Council (DRC) took effect from July 1.

The merge proposal was jointly progressed by both Cabonne Council and DRC throughout 2024 and 2025, with a formal application lodged with the Office of Local Government (OLG) on January 13 this year.

Extensive consultation was undertaken at various stages, including direct engagement with landowners and the broader Yeoval community.

To support the transition, Cabonne Council and DRC have entered into a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) outlining funding for key local infrastructure, including a shared pathway along Renshaw McGirr Way and updated street signage.

The adjustment reached its final stage following consideration by the Honourable Margaret Beazley AC KC, Governor of NSW on June 17, with formal notification received ahead of the July 1 commencement.

Mayor of Cabonne, Kevin Beatty said the adjustment represented a positive, community-driven outcome.

"This boundary adjustment reflects what the community has been advocating for over many years, bringing Yeoval together under one council to provide clearer, more consistent services," Clr Beatty said.

"We're pleased to be working collaboratively with Dubbo Regional Council to deliver this outcome and support the future of the Yeoval community."

DRC Mayor Josh Black said the decision made sense for everyone.

"This change finally unifies the North Yeoval community with Yeoval under the



banner of one single Council," he said.

"It's a practical, common-sense change and one that removes confusion and gives residents clear, straightforward access to the services they need."

"This is the kind of decision that puts community first, and it sets North Yeoval up for a strong future."

DRC will write directly to affected North Yeoval property owners in the coming weeks to formally advise of the change and what it means for their property.

Cabonne Council will assume responsibility for rates, services and enquiries from July 1 with further information to be provided to residents to support a smooth transition.

The initiative responds to long-standing community feedback and will unify the village of Yeoval under one local government area, aiming at improving service delivery and reducing confusion for residents.

Now one town under one council administration

YEOVAL TOWNSHIP and its people are no longer separated by a line on a map since 1885, says Yeoval historian and advocate to have North Yeoval consolidated with the rest of the town, Vicky Parkes.

"We are one township, one community and now under one council administration," she said. "This amalgamation to be administered by one Council has been a long time in the making."

Mrs Parkes said the amalgamation was first raised as an issue as far back as in the 1940s, by Councillor Sidney Johnson, who became Deputy Mayor of the old Amaroo Shire Council.

"In the 1970s his son Elvin Johnson, then Councillor, on the newly formed Cabonne Council again raised the issue," she said.

"For over 140 Years the township of Yeoval, has settled along both sides of Buckinbah Creek."

She said in 1885, Yeoval was mapped and divided into two County (Council) Areas, The Division Line being the middle of The Buckinbah Creek.

"The small community of Yeoval was split in two, this has caused community problems ever since."

* The Yeoval General Cemetery, was in Grundy Parish, Wellington County (northern side). If you died in Yeoval in the Buckinbah Parish, Gordon County (southern side). Your family had to get permission to bury you in another parish.

* North Yeoval grew with The Railway Station and its infrastructure. Several houses were built on the northern side of the Buckinbah Creek, most having a few acres around them, up to eighty residences and several streets were constructed in North Yeoval

...Continued on Page 2.

Inside
 this
 week

Brand new Eris Fleming short story -
Easter Saturday - Page 13

Outcomes from the June Ordinary Council Meeting

Mayoral Minute:
2026/2027 State Budget: The Mayor will write to the NSW Premier and Treasurer to acknowledge the 2026/2027 NSW Budget and express a strong desire to work in partnership with the NSW Government to deliver the infrastructure and services required for the growing region.
Reading between the lines: we should have received more money than we did.

Renewable energy projects Voluntary Planning Agreements:
Council will require renewable energy developers to base benefit payments on the NSW Benefit Sharing Guideline rates, adjusted for inflation from November 2023 to the date agreements are signed.
Council will update its Renewable Energy Benefit Framework to reflect this approach and use it in all future Voluntary Planning Agreement negotiations.
Council will also advise the Department of Planning, Housing and Infrastructure of this position and ask for the state guideline to be updated to match.

Reading between the lines: The State Government should have indexed the base rate to inflation, but didn't.

Support for campaign to increase Federal Assistance Grants to Local Government
Council will support the 'Invest in Us' campaign calling for an increase to Commonwealth Financial Assistance Grants for local government.
Council will promote the campaign locally, work with the media and the community and lobby Federal representatives to back the funding increase.
Council will also write to key Ministers urging their support for restoring funding to at least 1% of total Commonwealth taxation revenue, where it used to be, not the 0.49% that it sits at today.

There's lots to do locally these school holidays
Here's just a sample, but also check out the Wellington CFC facebook page:
School Holidays - What's on in Wellington.

* Bingo with a Trivia Twist; 11am, Thursday 9 July 2026; Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club; Free
* Pop Up Putt Putt Golf; face painting, games, playgroup and airbrush tattoos; 10am to 12pm, Monday 13 July; Cameron Park; Free; All ages welcome
For more information contact Maree on 0427 636 023

School Holidays
What's on at the Wellington Library
Join the Council team at the Wellington Library for some school holiday fun with free activities this school holidays. Sessions are suitable for ages 5 to 12 years and include:
* Colour Your Game - 10.30am to 12pm, Tuesday 7 July
Be ready to take on any challenge by creating a fun wrist band with sporty beads then design and decorate your own paddle ball game.
* Frame Your Game - 10.30am to 12pm; Tuesday 14 July
Put yourself in the game. Personalise a bag tag/key chain then decorate a sporty photo

frame where you are the star.
Bookings essential for Colour Your Game and Frame Your Game <https://events.humanitix.com/host/wellington-library>

Drop In Activities at Wellington Library
Join the team for scratch art, bean bag toss and a sports word find.
Monday 6 July to Friday 17 July; Ages 5 to 13; All day; No bookings required.
For more information on any of these activities contact the friendly team at the Wellington Library on 02 6840 1780.

A school holiday road trip to Dubbo
If you're looking for a bit of a road trip one day in the school holidays, then keep in mind that the Old Dubbo Gaol has lots of tours on offer over the next two weeks. A great option to do with the kids, friends and relatives, best of all you can get free access to the Old Dubbo Gaol simply for being a resident of the Dubbo Regional Local Government Area (Need to show photo ID as proof of residency).
Check out the different day and nighttours. Night tours have limited spaces available,

Volunteers needed for Wellington Eisteddfod

Returning to full schedule this year

WELLINGTON EISTEDDFOD Society is calling for volunteers to help deliver the 2026 Wellington Eisteddfod, which will run from July 28 to August 19.
The Eisteddfod has long relied on the dedication and generosity of local volunteers, with community members traditionally turning out in force to support performers, families and audiences throughout the event.
Following overwhelming community support and popular demand, the Eisteddfod is returning to a full schedule this year, with opportunities for volunteers to become part of one of Wellington's most loved community events.
Volunteers are needed across a wide range of areas both before and during the Eisteddfod, including: Front-of-house support; Backstage assistance; Publishing and formatting, including programs and certificates; Social media and digital content creation; Photography and videography.
This year, the Society is also introducing a new volunteer rostering system using the Connecteam app to make volunteering easier and more flexible.
Volunteers are encouraged to download the app and join the Wellington Eisteddfod Society <https://app.connecteam.com/#/ui?t=89d6f462&l=en-US>
The new system will allow volunteers to: View available shifts; Select times that suit them; Change or cancel availability easily; Receive confirmations and reminders; Access job descriptions and role

information.
Volunteer Coordinator Ailsa Comiskey said the new system would help streamline communication while making volunteering more accessible for everyone.
"We are so lucky to have such a strong sense of community amongst our volunteers here in Wellington," Ms Comiskey said.
"I lost count of how many people volunteered their time for one shift last year and then asked if they could be rostered on for more."
She acknowledged that introducing new technology can sometimes come with challenges and encouraged anyone experiencing difficulties to get in touch.
"We realise that new systems often have teething problems, so if anyone is unsure or has any difficulties using the app, please contact me and I'll happily help you through it."
Helping out at the Eisteddfod is a wonderful opportunity to relax and connect with others in the community.
Society President Jess Holland said we have found that our volunteers value their time and contribution to the Eisteddfod.
"It can be a great moment to pause the usual routine, catch up with a friend and enjoy being part of a much-loved community event.
"We greatly appreciate our volunteers, we would be lost without them."
Anyone interested in volunteering is encouraged to sign up through the Connecteam app or contact Volunteer Coordinator Ailsa Comiskey on 0437 737 931.

Council backs away from promised economic business review

DUBBO REGIONAL COUNCIL (DRC) has backed away from a Council resolution to compile and complete an Economic Business Review for the region ranging from Parkes to at least the Golden Highway (Dunedoo) and potentially to Newcastle in support of a new fit-for-purpose Scabbing Flat bridge.
The Scabbing Flat Bridge Action Group – Geurie Incorporation annual general meeting was told last week.
A resolution from a motion by Clr Richard Ivey (supported by all councillors) earlier this year was for Council to complete the review.
However, Association chair, Michelle Tomkins told the meeting that during a recent meeting with Council's new general manager, Andrew Wilshire with Luke Ryan and Mayor Josh Black, it became clear DRC resources were not available to complete the report.
Ms Tomkins said the next steps were to meet with Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development and identify potential

grant opportunities.
Ms Tomkins said for the association to apply for grants in its own right and in-conjunction with a government department as the lead, as some grants require this, DRC has been approached prior to the AGM to ascertain if they would support a DRC and an association grant submission.
"We are waiting for a response from DRC on this request," she said. "In parallel with the grant process, we will be seeking and assessing potential candidates/companies to complete the report.
"The association has been told on multiple occasions that there is no money at a state or local level.
"As a result of this feedback, we approached Transport For NSW prior to the AGM to ascertain if they would consider utilising grant money gained by the association to enable the commencement of feasibility studies that would be required prior to the commencement of building a new bridge
"Transport for NSW will not consider this offer."

All of Yeoval under one administration

...From Front Page.

After Dubbo Regional Council took over Wellington Council things got worse - which Council was responsible for water supply, sewerage and garbage collection to Nth Yeoval?
The zoning in North Yeoval was changed to Rural - this meant no new houses could be built in North Yeoval.
At the Council Elections North Yeoval Residences could not vote in Yeoval, because it was in a different Council area. North Yeoval residences had to drive into Wellington to vote.
In 2020, a concerned group of North Yeoval Residences began, advocating to both Dubbo Regional Council and Cabonne Council to amalgamate both Nth Yeoval and Yeoval under one Council.
Finally, after five years of negotiation between Cabonne Council and Dubbo Regional Council - an Agreement on Boundaries was drawn up and sent to the NSW State Planning and Mapping Authority.
The North Yeoval and Yeoval Council Boundaries Changes have been approved and Maps altered, Yeoval and North Yeoval as of 1st July 2026 will come under the administration and mapped area of Cabonne Council.
For Yeoval, this means the township and its people are no longer physically separated by a line drawn on a map in 1885. They are one township, one community under one council administration.

Wellington & District
LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O'Brien
Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Eucharreena to Elong Elong and Yeoval within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

Wellington & District Leader is independently published locally by Mark Griggs and Sharon Wilson trading as Wellington District Leader, 14 Nancarrow Lane, Wellington, NSW, 2820, ABN: 26847723165 and printed by Gilgandra Newspapers, another independent and both members of CPNSW.

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Community input and feedback is welcomed. Story leads, prepared articles and photographs can be forwarded to the publisher.

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Annemarie Jones OAM awarded Lions' Highest Honour

The Lions family of District 201N4 has reason to celebrate, with Lion Annemarie (Anne) Jones OAM recently being awarded the prestigious Ambassador of Goodwill Award, the highest recognition bestowed by Lions Clubs International.

The award was presented at the Multi District Convention in Adelaide by Third International Vice-President Tony Benbow, Past International President Barry Palmer and International Director Graeme Wilson.

Since joining the Geurie Lions Club in December 2011, Anne has demonstrated exceptional dedication to the Lions motto, "We Serve."

Her leadership journey "has included roles as Club President, Treasurer, Zone Chairperson, District Children's Health and Mobility Chairperson, District Convention Treasurer, and District Governor in 2017-2018.

Anne is perhaps best known throughout Australia for her outstanding work in disaster relief.

Following the Coonabarabran Fires in 2012, she was appointed District Disaster Relief Chairperson and has since led or coordinated Lions responses to major disasters including the Blue Mountains Fires, Forbes Floods, prolonged drought relief programs, the Hill End Fires, Cyclone Jasper recovery efforts, Townsville flood relief, and the Harden hailstorm recovery project.

Her expertise and commitment have seen her repeatedly appointed by Lions Clubs International and the Australian Lions Foundation to manage disaster relief operations across multiple districts.

One of her most significant achievements was administering the "Adopt a Family" flood relief project, which provided practical support to families affected by devastating floods across several Australian districts.

Beyond Lions, Anne has devoted decades to community service. She served as a Councillor, Deputy Mayor, and Mayor of Wellington Council and was elected to serve as a Councillor with Dubbo Regional Council.

Her extensive involvement with youth, aged care, disability services, community organisations, emergency services, and local government has earned widespread respect and admiration.

Her many honours include the Medal of the Order of Australia (OAM), Wellington Citizen of the Year, the World Leadership Award, the International President's Centenary Lions Award, and induction into the Australian Lions Foundation Hall of Fame.

District Governor Judy Ryan described Anne as a Lion who "reflects the highest ideals of Lions Clubs International," praising her tireless humanitarian service, inspirational leadership, and unwavering commitment to helping communities in times of greatest need.

Few Lions have demonstrated such a sustained and far-reaching impact.

Whether supporting families affected by disaster, leading community initiatives, or mentoring fellow Lions, Annemarie Jones OAM exemplifies the very best of lionism and is a worthy recipient of the Ambassador of Goodwill Award.



Anne Jones was awarded Lions Clubs International's most prestigious award in Adelaide recently.

Yoga Classes first and third Sunday each month

Tai Chi Classes on Fridays

**Empathetic Counselling
by Appointment 6845 4661**



Wellington Buddhist Centre
Tharpa Choeling Australia

Lions of Wellington raise \$2500 from High Tea



THANKS TO the recent Biggest High Tea, a raffle and the preloved book shop sales Wellington Lions has been able to donate \$2500 towards the Australian Lions Childhood Cancer Foundation.

Lions thanks everyone who helped and donated goods, Keirle's Pharmacy, Wellington Coles and Wellington Craft Co-op.

Pictured is Lions secretary Chris Hardy presenting 'Certificates of Appreciation' to Keirle's and Coles

Wellington.

The Preloved Book shop has moved to opposite the Commonwealth Bank, so, if the lights are on, come in and check out our larger easily accessible space and new stock.

We are still busy sorting it all out, so will not have a Grand Opening for a couple of weeks.

It was so good to be able to use Kimbell's Kitchen for the past year, we are so grateful for the owners.

Wellington Show Sheep results 2026

Border Leicesters

Champion Ewe – Bindaree Stud; Reserve Champion – Coinda Stud
Champion Ram – Bindaree Stud; Reserve Champion – Bindaree Stud
Poll Dorsets

Champion Ewe – Bocoble Stud; Reserve Champion – Pineleigh Stud
Champion Ram – Pineleigh Stud; Reserve Champion – Pineleigh Stud
Suffolk

Champion Ewe – Bruce Stanford; Reserve Champion – Bruce Stanford
Champion Ram – Bruce Stanford; Reserve Champion – Bruce Stanford

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Uungula towers being constructed

From Renew Economy writer
Joshua S Hill.

THE CONSTRUCTION the 414-megawatt (MW) Uungula wind farm by Squadron Energy has taken two important steps forward, with pre-installation of the site’s 69 turbines getting underway only days after the arrival of transformers for the project’s electrical infrastructure.

Squadron Energy announced on its LinkedIn account that transformers had arrived at the project’s site in Wellington, and were currently being installed.

This was followed up with the announcement that pre-construction of the wind farm’s turbines had begun, erecting the towers and installing the base sections for each turbine.

“This phase of construction represents strong momentum for Uungula Wind Farm, with teams now actively and safely assembling lower sections of each turbine tower,” Uungula wind farm project director, Sanjay Goel said.

“Seeing the first sections of the tower going up brings us a step

closer to delivering a project that will generate enough clean energy to power more than 200,000 homes and businesses.”

The Uungula project is currently the only wind farm currently under construction in NSW, which is still scrambling to secure enough new wind and solar capacity to replace the ageing coal fleet (still the largest in the country) which is due to retire over the coming decade.

At Uungula, three mid sections of the turbine tower are installed along with the base section, each of which weigh anywhere from 76 to 82 tonnes.

Once the four sections are in place they measure 83 metres tall, though the full height of each turbine will reach 148 metres.

The assist cranes used for the project will steadily complete pre-installation of one turbine at a time before moving on to the next.

Additional turbine components are set to be delivered to the site over the next few weeks, while the larger components are currently scheduled to begin transport at a later stage.



Panels being installed at Uungula Wind Farm. Squadron Energy photo.

PRAC payments for Regional Health students

IN PARLIAMENT recently, I stood alongside my Independent Crossbench colleagues to back a massive 43,000-strong national petition to call on the Federal Government to expand the Commonwealth Prac Payment scheme for all allied health and medical students.

We are in the middle of a rural doctor shortage crisis, and we simply don’t have enough allied health professionals working in country NSW and country Australia.



To fix this, we need to be bolstering our country health workforce, not making it harder for students to complete their studies!

Take Audrey, a medical radiation science student at Charles Sturt University.

She had to travel 2500 kilometres from Wagga to Queensland just to complete a four-week placement!

That highlights the immense hardship our regional students are facing.

The facts are clear: if students study in the country, they are much more likely to work in the country.

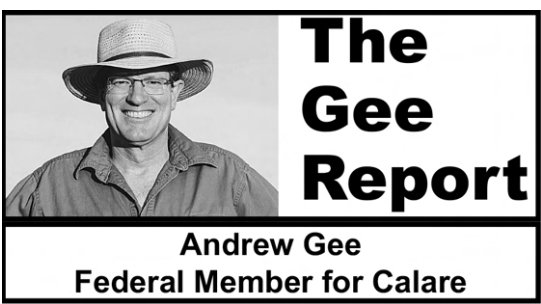
Let’s get these prac payments for our medical and allied health students and let’s get more of them into our regional universities!

My First Speech Competition

The My First Speech Competition is an exciting opportunity for young people in our school communities.

This is a national competition that welcomes students in Years 10, 11 and 12 to envision themselves as a newly elected Members of the House of Representatives and write a three-minute speech, focusing on a topic they’re passionate about.

One winner from each of year groups will present their speech to the Speaker and members live at Parliament House, receiving an expenses-paid trip to Parliament House in Canberra, including



flights and accommodation, and a prize pack valued at \$250.

As your Federal Member I highly encourage students in Years 10, 11 and 12 to get involved.

This is a great competition to develop as our future local leaders – learning about the work of the Australian Parliament and gaining experience in writing and public speaking.

For further information and entry submission, please visit the website: <https://mfs.houseofrepresentatives.gov.au/>

Entries to the My First Speech Competition close on 11.59pm AEST on Monday 20 July 2026.

Good luck!

Australia Post Grant

Applications are now open for the 2026 Australia Post Community Grants Program, offering grants of up to \$10,000 for community-led projects that help people connect and improve mental health and wellbeing in local communities.

An additional \$250,000 is available for projects supporting communities recovering from natural disasters or major storm events.

Eligible not-for-profit organisations are encouraged to apply.

Applications close: 6 July 2026 (11.59pm AEST).

For guidelines and eligibility information, visit <https://auspost.com.au/about-us/supporting-communities>



with Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld

I KNOW how to steal a car. I’ve seen the movies.

First, smash the window with my elbow. Ouch!

Then dive under the dashboard, pull out a bundle of conveniently colour-coded wires, twist a couple together, touch another to the starter motor and... vroom.

If I’m feeling particularly sophisticated, I might even slide some blue packing tape between the window and the door seal to save my elbow.

The modern problem? Damned electronics!

For many decades, stealing a car was largely a mechanical exercise.

Defeat the lock, defeat the ignition, and you were on your way.

Carmakers responded by making steering locks stronger and fitting alarms.

But the real revolution was invisible.

Australian Design Rule ADR 82/00 was introduced in 2001.

It required all new passenger vehicles to be fitted with electronic engine immobilisers

that would only deactivate once a chip inside the ignition key was recognised by the onboard computer.

Overnight, the old Hollywood hot-wire trick became largely useless because even if you could join the correct wires, the car’s computer simply refused to start the engine. And it worked!

145,000 vehicles were stolen in Australia in 2001 – the highest level on record.

At the time there were only 12.8 million registered vehicles on our roads.

Fast forward to today and Australia has more than 22 million registered vehicles.

Yet even with thefts recently climbing, up from a pandemic low of 44,000 to a current level of 65,000, annual thefts are still less than half the peak reached a quarter of a century ago.

But once a car could recognise an electronic key, someone had the bright idea of asking, “Why make the driver take the key out of their pocket at all?”

Enter keyless entry and push-button start.

Walk up to your car, grab the handle, press a

button and drive away.

Unfortunately, easy for you can sometimes mean easier for someone else.

Modern car thieves are attacking the convenience features. One of the most talked-about techniques is called a relay attack.

As you approach your keyless entry car, it asks, “Is that my key nearby?”

It sends out a low-power signal and if it hears the correct encrypted response, it unlocks and allows the engine to start.

A relay attack simply extends that conversation.

One device is positioned close enough to detect the key’s radio signal - perhaps just outside your front door.

A second device stands beside the car.

The two relay the encrypted conversation between the genuine key and the vehicle. The car believes its owner is standing beside it, unlocks the doors and starts without a single wire being twisted.

Alternatively, if you do see a modern thief under the dash, they are unlikely to be

twisting wires but more likely to be plugging equipment into the car’s onboard diagnostic (OBD) port - the same socket mechanics use for servicing.

Once connected, they can communicate directly with the vehicle.

Since Cadillac introduced the ignition key in 1910, we have had manufacturers creating new ways of protecting cars – and thieves working just as hard to overcome those defences.

Manufacturers recognise the problem with relay attacks and are now using Ultra-Wide-band to communicate between a phone with an app and a car – and that tells the car exactly how far away you are from your car.

OBD ports started changing once manufacturers realised they were being manipulated by thieves.

It turns out the biggest change in car theft wasn’t how we drive our cars. It was that somewhere along the way, our cars became computers.

And every computer, sooner or later, becomes a cybersecurity story.

Buckinbah to Yeoval – what’s in a name?

From the Yeoval Historical and Family Museum/O’Hallorans Cottage uncovers some of Yeoval’s history – how Yeoval got its name, its original connections to ‘Buckinbah’ squatter run and colonial settlement.

BEFORE COLONIAL settlement the area around Yeoval was the traditional hamelands of the Wiradjuri family mob, the ‘Murrung-Baa’ people (Wiradjuri meaning - Place of the Grey Box).

They made their camp on the banks the Balgan-Baa (Wiradjuri meaning - place of the boomerang - ie: the shape of ‘bend in The Buckinbah Creek’.

Benjamin Boyd was a colonial entrepreneur who established the Whaling Port of Boyd Town, on the NSW South Coast, he also ‘traded in’ slaves - ‘Blackbirding’ them from the South Sea Islands.

In 1840, Benjamin Boyd, ‘took up’ land from Wellington to Baldry (halfway between Yeoval and Parkes) then across to Obley (halfway between Yeoval and Dubbo) and back to Wellington.

He built a ‘Squatter Run’ on 66,000 acres naming it ‘Ganoo’ (Wiradjuri meaning - running water).

Boyd, was forced to flee the Colony of NSW, when bankruptcy and his unscrupulous activities began catching up with him.

He sailed for the Californian Goldfields in 1851, and stopped at Guadalcanal, for provisions (he had previously stolen young men off the Island, trading them into slavery).

Boyd was captured and be-headed and his head spiked and displayed in a Ceremonial Place.



Ben Boyd.

The huge ‘Gonoo’ Squatter Run of 66,000 acres was subdivided into three ‘Squatter Runs’.

1. Thomas MacCulloch ‘Obella’; 2. Nicolas Hyeronimus ‘Goonoo’; 3. Eleanor Terry ‘Buckinbah’ of 19,200 acres.

Eleanor Terry, held the Squatter Run of ‘Buckinbah’ for 10 years.

In 1858, when Eleanor sold ‘Buckinbah’, the buildings on the ‘Buckinbah Squatter Run’ comprised of

* A Superintendents Cottage (later becoming ‘The Stores Depot’); * Overseers Cottage (later becoming ‘The Paterson Family Home’); * Two Labourers Huts; * Woodshed, stockyards and gardens; * Eight Out-Station Buildings constructed as Farm Labourers Huts.

In 1861, The Robertson Land Acts were introduced through Parliament.

This enabled the Government to take back large Squatter Runs that did not have Title Deeds.

These resumed ‘Squatter Runs’ were then divided down into smaller farm acreage blocks.

The Government then auctioned these small farms and people were able to choose one of these blocks and bid on



A.B. ‘Banjo’ Patterson with his nanny, Fanny Hopkins at ‘Buckinbah’.

them.

If ‘the Bidder’ won, they then purchased the Block and the ‘Title Deeds’. - these people were known as ‘Selectors’.

This was a way for the Government to gain revenue. Andrew Bogle Paterson and his wife Isobella Rose (née Barton) ‘Selected’, bid and won the Buckinbah Overseers Homestead Farmland Block.

Andrew Barton Paterson (‘Banjo’), born in 1864 spent the first seven years of his childhood, growing up at ‘Buckinbah’.

Barty played along the banks of the Buckinbah Creek, with the children of his Aboriginal Nanny - Fanny Hopkins, she was the partner of an Irish convict - Andrew Hopkins (alias Flannery).

The Paterson family lost their ‘Wool Clip’ from a flood in the Buckinbah Creek.

In 1871 they were forced to move to ‘Illawong’ a property in the Yass District.

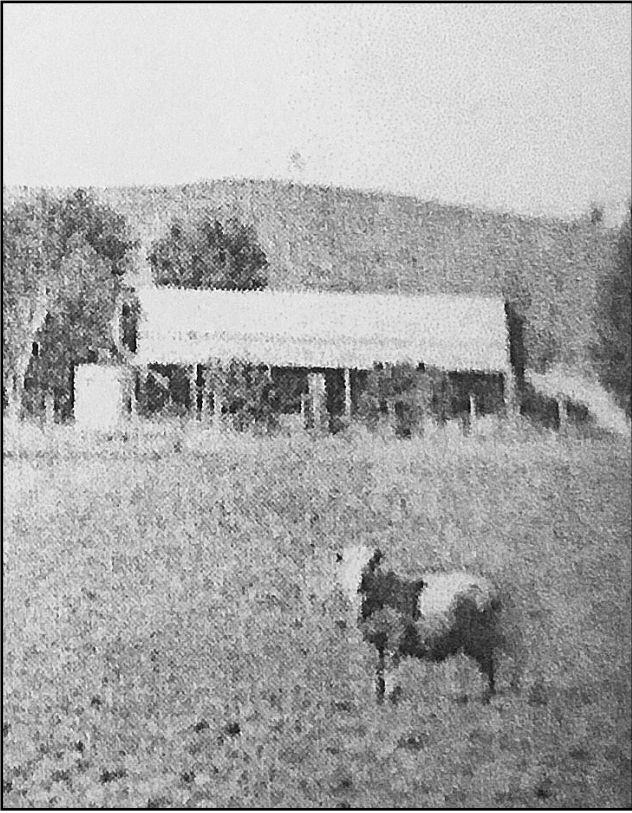
Gold was found around the area in 1864. Miners flocked in, crossing the Catombal Ranges from Hill End and Ophir Goldfields, Currajong and Bushman’s Goldfields at Parkes, from Gulgong and ‘10 Mile Holes’ near Tomingley.

The settlement around the ‘Buckinbah Stores/Depot’ grew rapidly with 23 Mines including ‘Goodrich Mine’ being opened up in the local area by 1868.

By 1882, the population of the settlement at ‘Buckinbah’ had grown to 300 people living permanently around the ‘Buckinbah’, Store Depot, operating as ‘The Buckinbah Stores Shop’.

This caused much confusion between mail deliveries to the ‘Buckinbah Station’ and the settlement of ‘Buckinbah’.

A Public Ballot was held to change the name of the



The Patterson family house which was on the ‘Buckinbah’ Overseers Homestead Farmland Block.

Buckinbah Settlement.

A family, from Yeovil, Somerset in England had settled in the area (there is a Somerset Drive on the northern side of the Buckinbah Creek).

The Family, won the Public Ballot and the Village of ‘Buckinbah’ was re-named YEOVAL, with the official opening of the Post Office in 1884.

Yeoval Residents are proud of their past, their Town and their Colonial History.

We invite you to come and celebrate at the ‘The Back to Buckinbah Festival - to be held at The Yeoval Sports Grounds on July 11.

Written by Victoria Parkes, The Yeoval Historical Society (Bibliography reference: Australian National Library, NSW State Library, Trove Newspaper records, Wiradjuri Language Dictionary, Local History Records - Yeoval Historical & Family Museum/O’Hallorans Cottage, Wikipedia).



Goldminers on the track for better tidings.

Editor,
THE HISTORY of our town has a significant place in the history of our country and many of today’s expressions of population concern, cautions and reactions are unsupported.

In our beginnings the relocation of the Aboriginal Settlement from “the confluence of the two rivers” to a less desirable four miles upstream on the Macquarie River, to enable the relocation of the Wellington Village, from the originally proposed site at Neurea, was never reported or supported as a “disputed relocation” as claimed by some activists today who want division, which is concerning for racial harmony.

Subsequently, innovative hard working Chinese immigrants mined gold here and created methods, and amazing infrastructure, to more efficiently mine and sluice the gold.

Their resultant wealth was resented by other miners and they were subjected to physical abuse and blatant unprotected theft despite giving no reason for concern or caution.

Chinese Immigrants were also first to develop Market Gardens on our Bell River Flats and they were hard workers and big Opium users in the evenings, in their own company, playing their board games and gambling.

Their wealth and drug induced enjoyment reportable attracted local Indigenous Women and due to Moral Concerns, expressed by the Town Community, Indigenous Women were barred by Police from these sorties unless they were married to one of the

Chinese present.

This apparently evolved to Indigenous/Chinese marriages and participation in, and Indigenous Income from, the lucrative Market Gardens which at one time was the biggest supplier to the Sydney Produce Market, and pickers were trucked from and to Nanima by the Chinese Market Gardeners.

Concurrent with this, and the dissipation of many concerns and cautions, the relationship with local farmers and business men grew and the employment of Indigenous workers with their natural abilities resulted in some very productive fulfilling outcomes right up into the 1970’s and 80’s.

Today we have known Educators and University Leaders, Doctors, Indigenous Snack and Tea Business owners, Land Rights and Manufacturing Business owners and Health Care Leaders, Shearers, Shed Hands, Plant Operators, Transport Drivers etc etc all Indigenous and all originating from Wellington.

Certainly, no reason for concern or caution here but unfortunately it’s there! Regrettably Activism, Claimed Entitlement and Expectation from Government by subsequent Indigenous generations have been a diversion to more mutually rewarding

growth in Indigenous Employment Participation, interaction and contribution and there is need for concern and caution in all this.

Wellington’s celebrated huge Fong Lee’s Store, at one time legitimately claiming to have “the largest range of roducts for sale in one store in the whole of Australia”, and a number of Produce Stores were all Chinese owned and operated profitably with substantial well reported contributions to community development and in spite of this many still treat the Chinese joining our communities negatively.

Australia’s Greek Milk Bars and Cafes found a place in Wellington very early in the history of our country, numbering Six in town at one stage.

Their Greek owners brought new personality and business acumen and multiculturalism came to town.

This was followed by immigrants from elsewhere all with differences but without exception something to contribute with no need for concern or caution.

As a final thought, it was once said to me “that a child only notices a colour or physical difference in their playmates when an adult points it out to them” and if you relate that to later life we do so often react to what we are told and not what we experience and great relationships are frequently the consequence.

Such is life.

Roger Everett

Letter to the editor

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LEADER

Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington
WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church
Sunday 9am
Sunday 5pm - The Gathering
MARANATHA
11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church
77 Swift Street
9:30am Sunday mornings
6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church
Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick’s Catholic Parish
Saturday
5pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington
8.30am - Stuart Town
Sunday
8am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
10am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month
10am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
8am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month
Weekday mass
Please check parish bulletin
In Christ Chapel
2pm Sunday

Everyone looks at the classifieds.

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Around the electorate with our State Member Dugald Saunders

A Stronger NSW
FOLLOWING THE release of Labor’s let-down 2026/27 Budget last week, Leader of the Opposition, Kellie Sloane, delivered her Budget-in-Reply speech on Thursday on behalf of the NSW Nationals and Liberal Coalition.

In her speech, Kellie outlined our plan for a stronger NSW, making a point to say Labor has had its chance and let the opportunity slip.

She also made it clear regional NSW deserves our fair share, whether it’s infrastructure, energy, housing or other essential services.

The Nationals and Liberal Coalition’s plan for a stronger regional NSW includes:

- * A Regional Infrastructure Guarantee, ensuring at least 25 per cent of all new infrastructure spending is directed to regional NSW
- * Restoring the Regional Seniors Travel Card to provide practical cost-of-living support for older Australians living in regional and rural communities
- * Payroll tax reform which will back regional jobs and businesses to unlock new

opportunities for growth across regional NSW

- * A \$300 million biosecurity and feral animal control program to protect agricultural production, strengthen biosecurity and support farmers and landholders
- * A fairer and more balanced energy transition by reducing pressure on regional communities, diversifying energy generation across NSW and helping place downward pressure on power bills for families and businesses

This is just the beginning of our plan for a stronger NSW, with more announcements to be made over the next few months.

Welcoming the Governor
It was a privilege to welcome NSW Governor, Her Excellency the Honourable Margaret Beazley AC KC and Mr Dennis Wilson to Dubbo on Saturday morning.

Their visit started with a meeting at the Dubbo Mosque with community leaders and other invited guests, where the Governor spoke on the vibrancy of our community and Mr Wilson reflected on his time growing up in Dubbo.

The Governor and Mr Wilson then went on to visit the PCYC to see KinderGym in action, before heading out to the NSW Rural Fire Service Training Academy at the airport.

This visit was the last stop in the Governor and Mr Wilson’s visit to the Central West and Orana region, which also included time in Orange, Dunedoo, Gilgandra, Gulgong and Mudgee.

Great Western Highway update
Following an accelerated procurement process, Seymour Whyte has been selected to construct a new crossing at Mitchells Causeway.

The new crossing will see a bridge structure built over the existing Mitchells Causeway, supported by deep piles anchored into the stable bedrock below.

The new structure will sit above, but independently of the convict-built causeway, which will be stabilised as part of the work.

Construction is due to start as soon as July and is expected to take a minimum of 12-months.

Stronger together
Applications are now open for the Stronger Together: Festival and Event Grants 2026/27.

This program provides grants of \$5000 to \$20,000 to support multicultural and multi-faith community groups in producing events that celebrate and embrace our state’s vibrant cultural diversity.

Events must be held between 1 October 2026 and 30 September 2027 to be eligible.

Applications close 4pm, Monday 13 July. For more, visit:<http://nsw.gov.au/grants-and-funding/stronger-together-festival-events-2026-27>

Sign the Petition
We need more overtaking lanes between Wellington and Dubbo!

To sign the petition and show your support, follow the prompts on my website www.dugaldsaunders.com.au

Until next time, Dugald

Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL
MEMBER FOR CALARE



GREAT WESTERN HIGHWAY ANNOUNCEMENT

Our communities have every right to be cynical and skeptical about last weeks announcement. Here is the truth of what we are looking at:

NO BUDGET, NO TIMETABLE:
They claim this work will be finished within 12 months, but we've all seen Government timelines blowout. Plus, they won't even tell us how much it's costing. Why the secret? It's taxpayer money.

NO IMPROVED ACCESS:
They are only installing one lane each way over the convict bridge. We aren't getting better access than we had

before - they could and should be doing more. Only a vague possibility of an unfunded 3rd lane in the distant future

WOEFULLY INADEQUATE SUPPORT:
Piddling one-off grants working won't save local businesses from closing their doors. Entire communities like Portland and Wallerawang have been left with absolutely nothing. A \$10,000 grant spread over a 12 month construction period is less than \$28 a day in support!

We don't know how long this disaster will continue. We don't need spare change - we need an ongoing support package like JobKeeper.

The NSW Government is dropping billions on the other side of the sandstone curtain while wreaking havoc on our region. It is simply not good enough.



ACEREZ IS NOT ABOVE THE LAW!

In Parliament recently, I called out transmission line developer ACEREZ for the shocking destruction of a Wiradjuri rock shelter.

This was no accident. The site was clearly marked. They knew it was there, and yet a deliberate decision was taken to destroy it. To make matters worse, they waited two full months to even notify Wiradjuri groups!

Because this is a New South Wales Government project, ACEREZ and EnergyCo seem to think they are completely above the law and can get away with corporate vandalism without consequence.

From orphaning native baby birds and flattening ancient wildlife corridors on Merotherie Road, to the wanton

destruction of irreplaceable cultural heritage - if anyone else did this, they'd be in the slammer in a heartbeat.

The Federal Environment Minister, Murray Watt, failed to take any real action when the devastation hit Merotherie Road, and we haven't seen any enforcement on this cultural heritage destruction either.

They investigate, but nothing ever happens! We are sick of the hypocrisy, the damage control, the spin, and the crocodile tears. ACEREZ must be held accountable and brought to heel!



STANDING UP FOR LAW ABIDING GUN OWNERS



In Parliament this year, I spoke against and voted against the Federal Government's rushed gun laws legislation.

The new gun laws were a political response to the evil crime committed at Bondi. Many people in the Central West were alarmed that the Federal Government's first reaction to this atrocity was to call for tighter gun controls rather than a Royal Commission that would hopefully shine a light on exactly what happened on the 14th of December 2025. This caused widespread anger amongst law-abiding gun owners in our region who

believe that the government has unfairly targeted and penalised them. Unfortunately, these new gun laws distract from the real issues. How it was that these terrorists got access to licensed firearms in circumstances when both of them were known to security services and at least one was on a watch list? How could they have travelled to known terrorist and extremist hotspots without alarm bells ringing? How did they slip through the net? And why aren't we going after the illegal guns that are the cause of so much violence in our streets? The criminals who own them are hardly going to be participating in a gun buy-back. In Calare, we have more than 17,000 firearm license holders. The government rushed the gun reforms through without giving our regional Australians the chance to have their say.

Everyone in our region supports genuine measures to make our communities safer, but we needed a response based on evidence and facts, and not politics.

That's why I voted against these laws. I will continue to stand up for law-abiding gun owners in the Central West, and I will continue to hold the government to account on this issue.

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For regular updates and news,
follow me on Facebook and
Instagram @andrewgeecalare



Authorised by Andrew Gee MP, Suite 1/179a Anson Street Orange NSW 2800

Insert the missing letters to make 10 words – five reading across the grid and five reading down.

L		S		S
	N		U	
S		O		E
	I		E	
S		E		S

Place each of the tiles of letters into the blank jigsaw below to create four six-letter words going across and down.

DO

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NO

There may be more than one possible answer.

Insert each number from 1 to 9 in the shaded squares to solve all the horizontal and vertical equations. Multiplication and division are performed before addition and subtraction.

×

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105

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52

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7

51

21

LEAVES
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EDGEWORD

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E	N	O	T	S
T	U	N	N	V
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5x5

	21		51		7	
	=		=		=	
12	=	2	+	6	+	1
		×		+		×
52	=	8	×	6	+	4
		+		×		+
105	=	5	×	7	×	3

CROSSMATH

TV

6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Gruen. 10.35 Guy Montgomery's Guy Mont Spelling Bee. Final. 11.20 QI. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 The Capture. 2.00 Parliament Question Time. 3.00 Restoration Australia. 3.55 Frankie Drake Mysteries. 4.40 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 Grand Designs. Return. 8.45 Grand Designs: 25 Years And Counting. 9.35 Ground Up. 10.05 Twenty Twenty Six. 10.35 ABC Late News. 11.05 Frankie Drake Mysteries. 11.50 Late Programs.

two

6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 South Aussie With Cosi. 2.30 Air Crash Investigations: The Accident Flies. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 RSPCA Animal Rescue. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Father Brown. 8.30 Grace. 10.30 Murdoch Mysteries. 11.30 Late Programs.

Entertains 1.20pm

Elementary. 2.00 ER. 2.40 Abbott Elementary. 3.05 QI. 3.35 Would I Lie To You? 4.05 MythBusters. 4.55 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 5.45 Grand Designs NZ. 6.30 House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 9.00 Gruen. 9.40 Late Programs.

7

6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.00 Beat The Chasers UK. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Home And Away. 7.30 Football. AFL. Round 17. Geelong v Brisbane Lions. 10.30 AFL Post-Game Show. 11.00 Kick Ons. 11.30 To Be Advised. 1.00 Brave New World. 2.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 NBC Today. 5.00 Sunrise Early News. 5.30 Sunrise.

mate

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.30 Mountain Men. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers: Best Of. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.00 Football. AFL. Geelong v Brisbane. 7.30 Highway Patrol Special. 8.30 Air Crash Investigations. 9.30 Homicide: With Ron Iddles. 10.30 **MOVIE**: Antlers. (2021) 12.35 Late Programs.

Family

6.00 Kids' Programs. 4.05 Andy's Dino Island. 4.20 Santiago Of The Seas. 5.30 Talking Tom Heroes. 5.55 PJ Masks. 6.45 HexVets And Magic Pets. 7.05 Batwheels. 7.35 Ninjago: Dragons Rising. 8.00 Young Sheldon. 8.25 Young Sheldon. 8.40 Ultimate Vets. 9.05 Animal Park. 9.50 The Secret Life Of The Zoo. 10.35 Late Programs.

9

6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 **MOVIE**: Steal Your Heart. (2023) Emma Elle Roberts, Robbie Silverman. 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 **A Current Affair**. 7.30 **Rugby League**. NRL Women's Premiership. Round 1. Cronulla Sharks v Newcastle Knights. 10.00 **Tennis**. Wimbledon. Day 4. 12.00 Tennis. Wimbledon. Day 4 Late. 5.00 Today Early News. 5.30 Today.

fliX

6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 The Great Day Out. 10.30 My Kitchen Rules. 12.00 Holey Moley Australia. 3.00 Frogger. 4.00 The Food Dude. 4.30 Extreme Weddings: Australia. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 Ramsay's Kitchen Nightmares USA. 9.30 Ramsay's Hotel Hell. 10.30 First Dates UK. 11.30 Late Programs.

NEWS

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.10 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.30 Finding Stars. 11.00 ABC Late News. 11.30 Late Programs.

10

6.00 Morning Programs. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Entertainment Tonight. 10.20 MasterChef Australia. 11.30 Farm To Fork. 12.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 10 News: Lunchtime. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 Taskmaster Australia. 8.40 NCIS. 9.40 10's Late News. 10.40 The Big Bang Theory. 11.30 Late Programs.

drama

6.00 Morning Programs. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 Building The Dream. 2.30 Bull. 3.30 JAG. 5.30 Bull. 6.30 Building The Dream. 7.30 NCIS. 8.30 Law & Order: SVU. 9.25 Boston Blue. 10.20 Blue Bloods. 11.15 JAG. 12.15 Late Programs.

Gem

6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 Midsomer Murders. 3.00 Antiques Roadshow. 3.30 **MOVIE**: Lady Godiva Rides Again. (1951) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 Wimbledon 2026 Pre-Show. 8.00 Tennis. Wimbledon. 10.00 The Brokenwood Mysteries. 12.00 Late Programs.

SBS

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.30 WorldWatch. 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.35 Fortress Britain With Alice Roberts. 8.30 Eva Longoria: Searching For France. New. 9.20 A Gentleman In Moscow. Final. 10.15 SBS World News Late. 10.45 FIFA World Cup 2026: Highlights Show. 11.15 Exit. 1.55 Merrill's Marauders: Burma WWII. 2.55 Great British Railway Journeys. 4.00 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 4.30 Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Round of 32. ESP v AUT.

comedy

6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 10.30 Becker. 11.00 Frasier. 12.00 Lingo. 1.00 Friends. 3.00 Frasier. 4.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 4.30 Becker. 5.00 The Big Bang Theory. 6.00 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 The Cheap Seats. 11.00 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.

VICELAND

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.45 WorldWatch. 5.50 Alone Netherlands. 6.40 Jeopardy! 7.35 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 8.30 Cup Fever! 9.00 Mysteries Unearthed With Danny Trejo. 9.50 The Americans. 10.45 Lee Lin Chin's Fashionista. 11.00 Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Round of 32. MEX v ECU. Replay. 2.00 Late Programs.

TV

6.00 Morning Programs. 10.30 Stuff The British Stole. 11.00 Race Around The World. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Portrait Artist Of The Year. 1.50 Ground Up. 2.15 Guy Montgomery's Guy Mont Spelling Bee. Final. 3.00 Restoration Australia. 3.55 Murdoch Mysteries. 4.40 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.35 Monty Don's British Gardens. 8.35 Saint-Pierre. New. 9.20 Gruen. 9.55 Would I Lie To You? 10.25 ABC Late News. 10.45 Guy Montgomery's Guy Mont Spelling Bee. Final. 11.30 Late Programs.

two

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 Imagine Holidays Iconic Rail Journeys. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.00 Escape To The Country. 6.00 Bargain Hunt. 7.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 8.00 Escape To The Country. 11.00 The World's Most Scenic Railway Journeys. 12.00 Late Programs.

Entertains 2.00pm

ER. 2.45 Abbott Elementary. 3.05 QI. 3.35 Would I Lie To You? 4.05 MythBusters. 4.55 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 5.45 Grand Designs NZ. 6.30 House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 **MOVIE**: The Talented Mr Ripley. (1999) 10.45 Late Programs.

7

6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.00 Your Money & Your Life. 1.30 Border Security: International. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies: Celebrity Specials. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 7.30 Football. AFL. Sydney v Western Bulldogs. 10.30 AFL Post-Game Show. 11.15 GetOn Extra. 11.45 Autopsy USA. 12.45 **MOVIE**: The Vows We Keep. (2021) 3.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 Million Dollar Minute. 5.00 NBC Today.

mate

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 Timbersports. STIHL Series. 3.30 Mountain Men. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers: Best Of. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.00 AFL: Friday Night Countdown. 7.30 Surveillance Oz: Dashcam. 8.30 **MOVIE**: Salt. (2010) 10.35 Late Programs.

Family

6.00 Kids' Programs. 3.25 Ready, Steady, Wiggle! 4.05 Andy's Dino Island. 4.20 Santiago Of The Seas. 5.30 Talking Tom Heroes. 5.55 PJ Masks. 6.45 HexVets And Magic Pets. 7.05 Gardening Australia Junior. 7.30 **MOVIE**: 200% Wolf. (2024) 9.10 Caper Crew. 10.00 MythBusters "There's Your Problem!". 10.50 Late Programs.

9

6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 **MOVIE**: A Slice Of Chicago Romance. (2021) Megan Elizabeth Barker. 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 **Rugby League**. NRL. Round 18. Penrith Panthers v South Sydney Rabbitohs. 9.55 NRL Friday Night Footy Post-Match. 10.45 Tennis. Wimbledon. 12.00 Tennis. Wimbledon. Day 5 Late. 5.00 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 5.30 Postcards.

fliX

6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 Manu's American Road Trip. 2.30 Malaysia Kitchen. 3.00 Starstruck. 4.30 **MOVIE**: Playmobil: The Movie. (2019) 6.30 **MOVIE**: Babe. (1995) 8.30 **MOVIE**: My Best Friend's Wedding. (1997) Julia Roberts, Cameron Diaz, Dermot Mulroney. 10.40 **MOVIE**: Along Came Polly. (2004) 12.40 Late Programs.

NEWS

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 News. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.35 ABC Evening News. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.35 If You're Listening. 9.00 The World. 9.30 Foreign Correspondent. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.30 Late Programs.

10

6.00 Morning Programs. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Entertainment Tonight. 10.20 Taskmaster Australia. 11.30 Farm To Fork. 12.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 10 News: Lunchtime. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 Selling Houses Australia. 8.40 Have You Been Paying Attention? 9.40 10's Late News. 10.40 The Big Bang Theory. 11.30 Late Programs.

drama

6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Days Of Our Lives. 8.45 The Young And The Restless. 9.30 JAG. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 Building The Dream. 2.30 Bull. 3.30 JAG. 5.30 Bull. 6.30 Building The Dream. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 Bull. 11.15 JAG. 1.15 Home Shopping.

Gem

6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 **MOVIE**: Mr Forbush And The Penguins. (1971) 3.05 Antiques Roadshow. 3.35 **MOVIE**: Beautiful Stranger. (1954) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 Wimbledon 2026 Pre-Show. 8.00 Tennis. Wimbledon. 10.45 **MOVIE**: Lethal Weapon 4. (1998) 1.15 Late Programs.

SBS

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.30 Bettany Hughes: History Of Mother Earth. 4.30 Nefertiti: The Raiders Of The Lost Tomb. 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.35 Paul Merton: Driving Amazing Trains. 8.30 Rain Bombs. 9.25 No Hamburg. No Beatles. 10.25 SBS World News Late. 10.55 FIFA World Cup 2026: Highlights Show. 11.25 The King. 12.20 The Typist. 1.30 Her War. Her Story: WWII. 2.30 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 3.30 Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Round of 32. AUS v EGY.

comedy

6.00 Morning Programs. 9.00 Family Feud. 10.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 10.30 Becker. 11.00 Frasier. 12.00 Lingo. 1.00 Friends. 3.00 Frasier. 4.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 4.30 Becker. 5.00 The Big Bang Theory. 6.00 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.

VICELAND

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.05 Bamay. 3.40 WorldWatch. 5.40 Inside The Huddle. 6.10 Over The Black Dot. 6.40 Jeopardy! 7.35 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 8.30 Cup Fever! 9.00 Mysteries Unearthed With Danny Trejo. 9.50 The Americans. 10.45 Lee Lin Chin's Fashionista. 11.00 Late Programs.

7

6.00 NBC Today. 7.00 Weekend Sunrise. 10.00 The Morning Show: Weekend. 12.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 1.00 Surf Patrol. 1.30 Football. AFL. GWS Giants v Fremantle. 4.30 Border Security: International. 5.00 Seven News At 5. 5.30 Border Security: Australia's Front Line. 6.00 Seven News. 7.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 8.00 The Great Outdoors. Return. 8.30 **MOVIE**: Jurassic Park. (1993) Sam Neill, Laura Dern, Jeff Goldblum. 10.55 To Be Advised. 12.35 **MOVIE**: Love At Sky Gardens. (2021) 2.30 Late Programs.

mate

6.00 Morning Programs. 1.30 Lady Torque TV. 2.00 Rides Down Under: Workshop Wars. 3.00 Motor Racing. National Drag Racing C'ship. Nitro Champs. 4.00 Duck Dynasty. 5.00 Counting Cars. 6.00 Pawn Stars. 7.00 Storage Wars. 7.30 **MOVIE**: Back To The Future Part III. (1990) 9.55 **MOVIE**: Midnight Run. (1988) 12.45 Late Programs.

Family

6.00 Kids' Programs. 3.55 Odd Squad. 4.10 Dino Dex. 5.10 Octonauts And The Amazon Adventure. 5.35 Super Monsters. 6.05 PJ Masks. 6.25 Emerald. 7.05 Let's Go Bananas! 7.30 Kids Baking Championship. 8.10 Kids BBQ Championship. 8.55 Chopped Junior. 10.00 Fresh Off The Boat. 10.40 Late Programs.

9

6.00 Getaway. 6.30 A Current Affair. 7.00 Weekend Today. 10.00 Today Extra: Saturday. 12.00 Great Australian Detour. 12.30 Rugby League. NRL Women's Premiership. Titans v Roosters. 2.30 NRLW Wrap. Return. 3.15 Rugby League. NRL Women's Premiership. Dragons v Canberra Raiders. 5.00 9News First At Five. 5.30 Getaway. 6.00 9News Saturday. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Rugby Union. Nations C'ship. AUS v Ireland. 10.00 Nations Championship: Australia v Ireland Post-Match. 10.30 Tennis. Wimbledon. 12.00 Late Programs.

fliX

6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 Malaysia Kitchen. 12.30 Yummy Mummies. 1.30 Australia's Cheapest Weddings. 2.30 This Is Your Life. 4.30 Instant Hotel. 5.30 **MOVIE**: Babe: Pig In The City. (1998) 7.30 **MOVIE**: The Da Vinci Code. (2006) Tom Hanks. 10.40 **MOVIE**: Nomadland. (2020) 1.00 Late Programs.

NEWS

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 ABC News. 3.30 That Pacific Sports Show. 4.00 ABC News. 4.30 Compass. 5.00 ABC News. 5.30 Asia News Week. 6.00 Evening News. 6.30 Stateline. 7.00 National News. 7.30 Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. Final. 8.10 Four Corners. 9.00 ABC Nightly News. 9.30 Late Programs.

10

6.00 Tough Tested. 7.00 Reel Action. 7.30 Escape Fishing With ET. 8.00 IFISH. 8.30 On The Fly. 9.00 All 4 Adventure. 10.00 Pat Callinan's 4x4 Adventures. 11.00 Intrepid Adventures. 11.30 Farm To Fork. 12.00 MasterChef Australia. 1.00 Good Food Everyday With Gary Mehigan. 1.30 Frugal Foodie. 2.00 Deal Or No Deal. 2.30 Millionaire Hot Seat. 3.00 The Finish Line. 4.00 Lingo. 5.00 10 News. 6.30 The Dog House Australia. 7.30 Selling Houses Australia. 9.30 Ambulance UK. 11.30 FBI. 12.30 Home Shopping. 5.00 Hour Of Power.

drama

6.00 Home Shopping. 9.00 Reel Action. 9.30 Pat Callinan's 4x4 Adventures. 10.30 Navigating The World. 11.30 Pooches At Play. 12.00 So Help Me Todd. 1.00 The Living Room. 3.00 JAG. 5.00 Escape Fishing With ET. 5.30 JAG. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 JAG. 12.15 Home Shopping.

Gem

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 Rugby Union. Shute Shield. Eastwood v Gordon. 5.00 Rugby League. NRL Women's Premiership. Broncos v North Qld Cowboys. 7.00 Keeping Up Appearances. 7.30 Wimbledon 2026 Pre-Show. 8.00 Tennis. Wimbledon. 10.30 **MOVIE**: The Courier. (2020) 12.40 Late Programs.

SBS

6.00 Morning Programs. 5.00 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 5.30 Operation: March On Rome. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Jewels Of The Mediterranean. 8.20 National Parks From Above: Ireland. 9.20 Railway Revolution: How Trains Shaped Our World. 10.55 FIFA World Cup 2026: Highlights Show. 11.30 Snowpiercer. 12.25 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 12.55 Cycling. Tour de France. 3.45 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 4.15 Bamay. 5.00 NHK World English News Morning. 5.15 Euronews. 5.30 ANC Philippines The World Tonight.

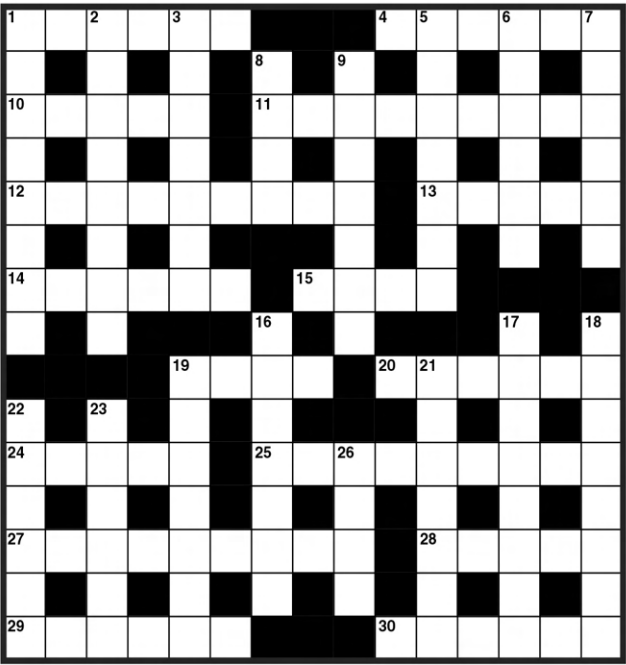
comedy

6.00 Good Chef Bad Chef. 7.00 The Bold And The Beautiful. 9.30 Millionaire Hot Seat. 11.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 11.30 Ridiculousness. 1.00 Friends. 6.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.30 Ridiculousness. 12.00 Home Shopping.

VICELAND

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.45 WorldWatch. 5.45 Mastermind Australia. 6.45 The Mega-Brands That Built The World. 7.35 Abandoned Americana. 8.30 Cup Fever! 9.00 The Death Coast. 9.50 The Americans. 10.40 The Swiping Game. 11.00 Late Programs.

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS**

1 Underground railway (6)

4 Water-surrounded land (6)

10 Chickens, pigeons etc. (5)

11 Social exclusion (9)

12 Provider of information (9)
- 13 Rainforest vine (5)

14 Of Troy (6)

15 Over (4)

19 Currency unit (4)

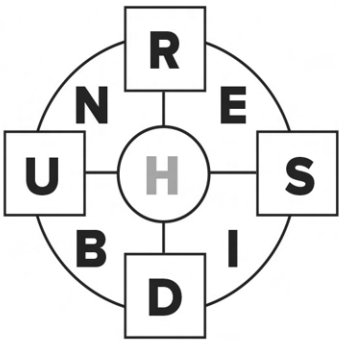
20 Antelope with lyre-shaped horns (6)

24 Happen (5)

9-LETTER No. 185

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in “s”.

- Today's Aim:
- 20 words: Good
- 30 words: Very good
- 40 words: Excellent



- 25 Encouraging (9)
- 27 Male name (9)
- 28 Proclaimer (5)
- 29 Proof-corrector (6)
- 30 Fruit (6)
- DOWN**
- 1 Temperance (8)
- 2 Shoeless (8)
- 3 German-speaking country (7)
- 5 Mollusc (7)
- 6 Shoe brand (6)
- 7 Humiliate (6)
- 8 Scottish island (4)
- 9 Law (7)
- 16 Bedbound (7)
- 17 Italian church (8)
- 18 Large marsupial (8)
- 19 Procession (7)
- 21 North African country (7)
- 22 Deadbeat (6)
- 23 Outline (6)
- 26 Sham (4)

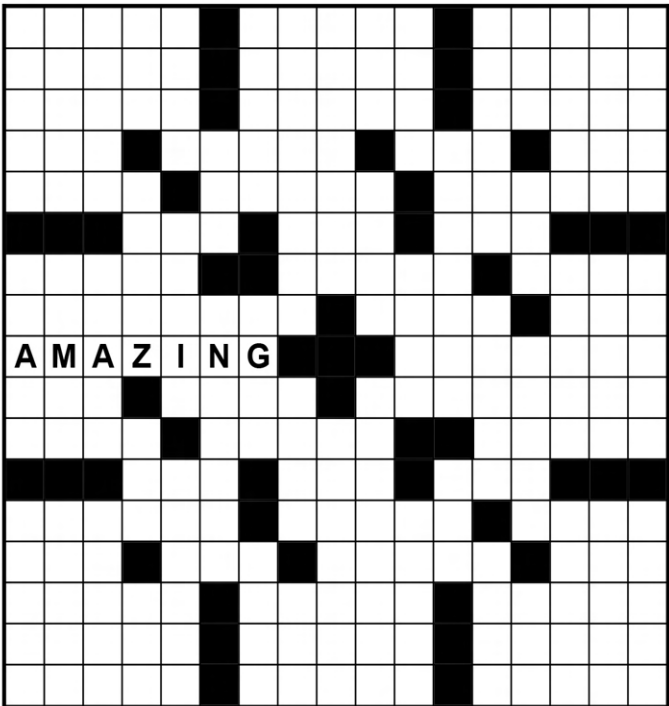


behind, brush, brushed, burnish, burnished, bush, bushier, dish, heir, herb, herd, herds, hers, hide, hides, hind, hinder, hinders, hire, hired, hires, hubris, hued, inrush, rush, rushed, shed, shield, shier, shin, shine, shined, shine, shire, shred, shine, shrub, shun, unshed, usher

WORDFIT

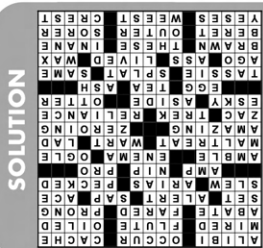
- 3 LETTERS**
- ACE
- AGO
- AIR
- AMP
- ASH
- ASS
- ATE
- BET
- COO
- EGG
- HUE
- LAD
- LAP
- NIP
- NOR
- PRO
- SAP
- SET
- TEA
- UTE
- WAX
- WEE
- YES
- ZAC
- 5 LETTERS**
- ABATE
- AGREE
- ALERT
- ALIBI
- AMASS
- AMAZE
- AMBLE
- ARIAS
- ASIDE
- AVERT
- AWARE
- BERET
- BLACK
- BRAWN
- CACHE
- CLOAK
- CREST
- EDGED
- EDGER
- ENEMA
- EXERT

- 4 LETTERS**
- AGES
- DISC
- ESKY
- IDEA
- KITS
- MAZE
- OGLE
- REDS
- SAME
- SLEW
- SPEW
- FLUTE
- GLINT
- HENCE
- INANE
- IRATE
- LANCE
- LIBEL
- LIVED
- MAMAS
- MANES
- MERIT



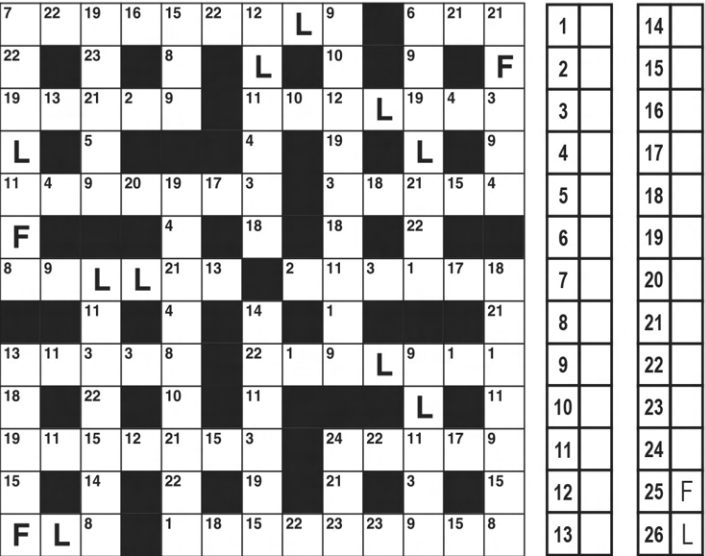
- MIRE
- OATHS
- OCCUR
- OFFER
- OILED
- OTTER
- OUTER
- PRONG
- SOARS
- SORER
- SPLAT
- TABBY
- THESE
- TRIOS
- WALTZ
- WEEST
- YESES
- ZEROING

- 6 LETTERS**
- COPPER
- GIANTS
- PECKED
- TASSIE
- 7 LETTERS**
- AMAZING
- APPAREL
- CURTAIN
- DEplete
- ENRAGES



CODEWORD

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?

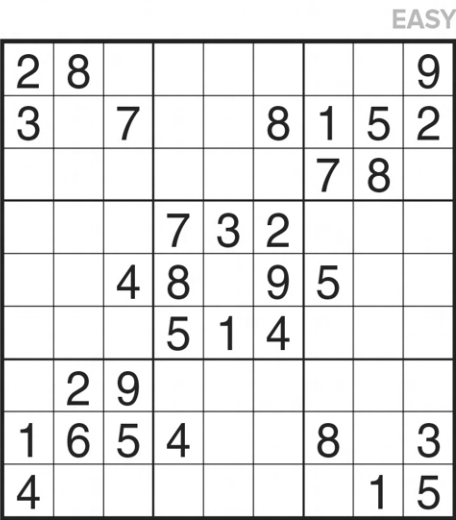


13 = W, 14 = G, 15 = R, 16 = D, 17 = C, 18 = H, 19 = A, 20 = X, 21 = O, 22 = U, 23 = B, 24 = J

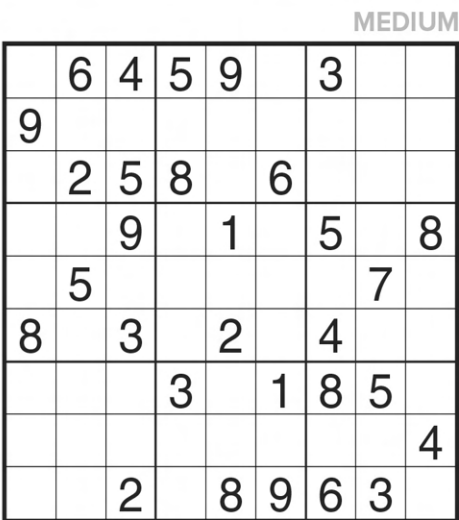
No. 135

SUDOKU

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.

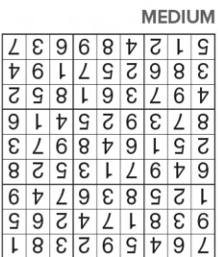
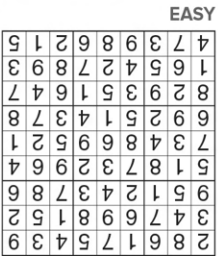


EASY



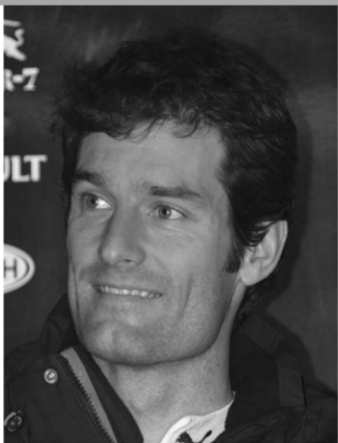
MEDIUM

SOLUTIONS



QUICK QUIZ

- In what century was the House of Medici founded?
- What do you call an extreme or irrational fear of heights?
- Windhoek is the capital and largest city in which African country?
- What was the name of the world's first female prime minister?
- In which Australian state is Mount Keira located?
- What sport is played with stones and brooms?
- In what state and year were Australian women first granted suffrage?
- Australian Mark Webber (pictured) won his first Formula One Grand Prix at which race?
- Italy is subdivided into how many regions?
- Cartoonist Gary Larson is famous for which comic strip?



ANSWERS: 1. 13th 2. Acrophobia 3. Namibia 4. Sirmavo Bandaranaike 5. NSW 6. Curling 7. South Australia, 1894 8. 2009 German Grand Prix 9. 20 10. The Far Side

WORD SEARCH

No. 095

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- | | | |
|----------|-----------|---------|
| BELOVED | HARRY | ORLANDO |
| BFG | POTTER | PERFUME |
| BUDDEN- | HOBBIT | RAGTIME |
| BROOKS | HOLES | UBIK |
| CASTLE | ILIAD | ULYSSES |
| DON | LOLITA | WAR AND |
| QUIXOTE | LOVING | PEACE |
| DRACULA | MATILDA | WONDER |
| EMMA | MIDDLE- | |
| FRANKEN- | MARCH | |
| STEIN | MOBY-DICK | |
| GILEAD | MONEY | |
| GREAT | ON THE | |
| GATSBY | ROAD | |

SECRET MESSAGE: There is no friend as loyal as a book

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AGRI TOPICS

Information for the
Man on the Land

For More Information
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Mb: 0428 635 994

While Michael is not penning this week’s column, he asked his grandson, Nicholas Hausler to fill in for him.

I HAVE the privilege of writing a section of this week’s Agri Topics, which I see as a great opportunity to give something back to Grandpa, especially through agriculture - a passion we have always shared.

Hello, my name is Nicholas Hausler. I am the fourth eldest grandchild of Michael and Carol White and the son of Tim and Julia Hausler.

I grew up just across the Murray River in the small Victorian town of Warracknabeal, where my passion for agriculture first began.

Today, I am studying a Bachelor of Agricultural Business at Marcus Oldham in Geelong, and to say I love it would be an understatement.

I am surrounded by like-minded people who all share a passion for agriculture and a drive to build successful careers within the industry.

We all have our own goals, but we work together to make the most of every opportunity presented to us. I am studying a Bachelor of Agribusiness which is a two-year course and have completed two years of practical learning before starting at Marcus Oldham.

Since finishing Yr 12, I have worked on a Queensland cattle station and then on a large WA cropping/sheep enterprise at Kojonup.

At Marcus Oldham the course program is a mix of theory and practical learning. We get to hear from established leaders from many agricultural enterprises and also go on field visits to compliment this learning.

I feel incredibly fortunate to be pursuing a career in an industry that has played such an important role in our family, and I hope to continue building on the passion that Grandpa has passed down to me. Wishing everyone a safe and hopefully successful season ahead.

By Angus Brown of AuctionsPlus

The bullish market is currently siding, the EYCI nudging the 1000¢/kg cwt level late last week.

The EYCI was at 999¢/kg cwt last Friday.

Interestingly the first time the EYCI breached 1000¢ was in July 2021, after which it continued rising until peaking in late January 2022 at 1190¢/cwt.

For those expecting a repeat there are some differences. The national herd was two million head, or 7 per cent smaller in 2021, and we were in the middle of a three-year La Nina.

The current price rally appears more like the winter price rallies of old, before easing in spring as supply improves. As usual cattle buy prices vary widely, but most Angus Steers around 300kgs are making 600-650¢/kg lwt..The potential spread sell price scenarios are currently extreme. Firstly, the middle scenario, with feeders at around the current prices of 5.30/kg lwt. The bullish view has feeders at 650¢/lwt next year, returning a very healthy \$1095/hd at 60pc gross margin. This feeder price would put quite the squeeze on lot feeders, who would need a finished cattle price north of 1000¢/kg cwt to get out of \$2925 feeder steers. The bearish view is the one where El Nino hits. The herd is sold down and overwhelms processing capacity. Grain prices move above \$400/t and young cattle prices tank. A feeder price of 400¢/kg cwt brings negative returns, and it could be worse than that. It was only 18 months ago when feeder cattle prices were around 350¢.

Note that this trade calculation does not include feed, freight, treatments, or administrative costs. These will differ between enterprises and should be assessed individually when considering any trade.



Dubbo (02) 6885 0549



Wellington 0427 919 062

WEEKLY MARKET REPORT

Week ending June 26, 2026

AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week \$52/25	This Week M52/25	Last Sale \$51/25	Sydney Change	Last Year Sydney	Sydney Yearly Change
17	2662	2649	2761	-99	1658n	+1004
18	2553	2578	2626	-73	1589	+964
19	2335	2372	2429	-94	1494	841
19.5	2235	2267	2340	-105	-	-
20	2155n	2187	2251n	-96	1432n	+723
21	-	2132n	-	-	-	-
28	-	872	880n	-	475n	-
MC	1254n	1219n	1264n	-10	704n	+550

Swift correction for last sale of season

THE CHALLENGING trading environment for Merino fleece bubbled through the surface in last week’s wool market, with large losses recorded. Not even a weaker Australian dollar could shield growers from what was coming. From the outset, prices were softer across all three selling centres in the Merino indicators, with skirtings unable to dodge the falling market as it had over the past couple of weeks. Cardings were in buyers favour with minimal falls, whilst crossbreds again recorded gains to go against the grain to see the 26-micron indicator lift 55 cents. Falls mainly happened on opening day, not over a couple of weeks making trading conditions more difficult. Buyers are hoping that this reset will allow confidence to grow again from both top makers and spinners. This sale concluded of the 2025/26 season, highlighted by how strong the market has been over the past 12 months. Almost all the low points start on the 1st of July, and the highest levels are over the last two weeks. The EMI started the year at 1208 cents and made it to 1989 cents just two weeks ago, which works out to be 64.7%. The finer end at 17 and 18-micron had been at levels that had seen enterprise changes occurring

due to lack of profitability, lifted 1084 and 1052 cent respectively, between 65 and 66.5%. Middle to broader Merino, 19-22 micron rose between 947 to 732 respectively, or 63.6 to 52.6%, but the head turning results were in the crossbreds, with 26 and 28 indicators up 508 and 392 cents, or at whopping 74.4 and 81.6% increase for the season. Where growers can really see these results is in their own bale averages, with many clips regardless of where they are from and what their test results are like for their predominantly Merino clips, receiving \$2000 per bale or better. It certainly hasn’t been an easy season to run sheep, but the rewards are such that people can now confidently hold and feed stock for long periods of time if required, with national sheep numbers at 100-year lows and demand for lamb, mutton and wool at levels that have those self-replacing flocks at the top of the gross margin farm enterprises. This week is the opening of the 2026/27 selling season, with four sales before a three-week recess. 33,489 bales catalogued for Wednesday and Thursday, fitting in with the beginning of the financial year. Macwool and Carmichael wool is offering 1450 bales today.

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS



Plasto & Company Livestock and Property

Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE.. 2158 head. Young cattle to trade 10c dearer, yearlings to 546c/kg. Feeder steers and heifers 8c to 10c dearer, steers 480c to 636c/kg, heifers 450c to 558c/kg. Young cattle to restockers and back-grounders considerably dearer, steers 456c to 668c, heifers to 580c/kg. Grown steers and heifers firm, steers 440c to 492c/kg, heifers 435c to 498c/kg. Cows to processors 6c to 8c dearer, 2 and 3 scores 360c to 410c/kg. Heavy cows 406c to 448c, ave 422c/kg. PTIC cows to restockers to 456c/kg. Heavy bulls to 425c/kg.

DUBBO LAMBS.. 9950 head. Numbers similar for fair quality. Fair numbers trade lambs, odd pens of heavy weights. Also some very well finished Merino lambs along with a lot of mixed lots and secondary types. Light lambs to processors \$9 cheaper, 12kg to 18kg 2-scores \$179 to \$223. Trade lambs firm to \$5 cheaper, 20kg to 24kg \$215 to \$315, ave 1200c to 1250c/kg cwt. Heavy lambs \$8 cheaper, 24kg to 30kg \$295 to \$350, over 30kg to \$384, ave 1180c/kg cwt. Quality Merino lambs \$5 cheaper, trade weights \$235 to \$292, heavies to \$344. Restockers and feeders remained very active, crossbreds \$139 to \$262, feeders paid to \$288. First-cross ewe lambs to restockers \$287 to \$294. Hoggets dearer to \$309 for crossbreds, \$270 for Merinos.

MUTTON.. Numbers back considerably, 2640 head. Most grades \$10 to \$20 cheaper. Merino ewes \$120 to \$340, crossbred ewes \$130 to \$340. Merino wethers \$186 to \$288, most sheep 870c to 985c/kg cwt.

WOOL.. It was certainly not the best way to close out the 2025/26 season with the market ending a five week up trend. Four weeks of gains were given back over the course of the two selling days with the NRI finishing on the same level as May 22. The majority of the falls were on the first day with the North falling 51 cents before somewhat stabilising on the final day, registering a further 5-cent decline. Most of the losses were attributed to the Merino fleece types with Skirtings, Cardings and Crossbreds propping up the market and helping overall averages. Now for the good news, the 2025/26 season has seen prices average 37.5% better than the previous two seasons. The market is up 60% from the start of the season. This week’s start to the new season is the second highest season starting price on record, surpassed only by the start of the 2018/19 season. 21,822 bales sold last week with the passed-in rate climbing to what is most likely a seasonal high of 16.6% (the average for the season was 6.3%). Normal buying patterns continued unabated but obviously at reduced price levels. The new season commenced this week and will run for four weeks before pausing for a three-week recess. Sales will be conducted on Wednesday and Thursday to avoid crossover with the end of the financial year.

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Dubbo

FOLLOWING THE qualifying Heats earlier in the month, the 1300 metres Dubbo RSL Club Winter Country Classic Final shaped as an enthralling contest at Dubbo on Sunday and such was the case when the majority of the field was stretched across the track inside the last 200 metres.

The front runner Yiasou (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$8.50) from the Brett Thompson stable was clinging to a slender lead but in the final stride was joined by the Michael Mulholland trained Jama-cri (Mikayla Weir, \$6.50) and a dead heat for first was declared with the top weight Talkachino (Jacob Stiff, \$5 equal favourite) also trained by Mulholland, a close third.

Yiasou, a last start winner at Warren, had finished third behind Talkachino and Green Pineapple in the Dubbo Heat for the male horses while Jamacri was runner-up to Kelilah in the Heat for the fillies and mares.

Michael Mulholland with Jasper’s Way, made the right decision when stepping the promising young stayer up in distance to the 2200m of the Dubbo Rhino Lodge Benchmark 66 Handicap after recent placings over shorter trips at Warren, Rosehill and in the Parkes Cup.

Owned by Kel Turner from Dubbo, Jasper’s Way (Nick Palmer, \$3.10 fav) had a nice run behind the leading trio and raced to an over five-lengths win from Spacetime Legend (Grant Buckley, \$4.40) and Bill Peyto (Anna Weatherlake, \$26).

Rapidly emerging apprentice Nick Palmer was also responsible for an outstanding ride on the Brett Robb trained The Mailer in the 1100m North Dubbo RSL Super Maiden Plate.

A recent addition to the Robb stable after five starts in Victoria, The Mailer (\$8) was well back turning for home before weaving through the field and coming with a late charge on the inside to claim a close decision over Panelli (Clayton Gallagher, \$2.70) and Gold Finger (Jacob Stiff, \$7.50).

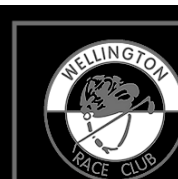
Mendooran trainer Jane Clement continued her incredible run of success, with Flee With Me (Jacob Stiff, \$3.40 fav) the first leg of a double when just lasting to beat Litlfela (Jenny Duggan, \$15) and Adamana (Clayton Gallagher, \$4.20) in the 1400m Dubbo RSL Motel Maiden Handicap.

Apprentice Gabrielle Johnston was aboard the Jane Clement trained Prince Of Sepang (\$11) which burst through the pack to win the Dubbo RSL 178 Restaurant Benchmark 66 Handicap by a length from Deion (Jasmine Urquhart-Warren, \$11) and Bolo Miss (Mathew Cahill, \$2.60 fav).

Racing in great form this campaign, the Clint Lundholm trained Stockholm is likely to be set for country Cups after winning the 1600m One More Event Benchmark 82 Handicap.

Taking the mid race lead, Stockholm (Zoe Hunt, \$2.60 fav) held on to beat Blacklist (Kody Nestor, \$5.50) and Lockdown Gamble (Jasmine Urquhart-Warren, \$7) in a close finish.

The other winners were the Bob Howe, Mudgee trained Tarendosetta (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$8) and Irish Jig (Izzy Neale, \$3.60 fav) trained at Scone by Scott Singleton.



WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

Racing at Wellington

This SUNDAY

5 JULY

Make it a family day out

The latest Eris Fleming’s Short Story starts today

Easter Saturday

A champ gets up when he can’t” Jack Dempsey.

Chapter 1

Easter Saturday — Caleb — Killarney Castle — crucified cats — a murderous time.

“IN THE sixties the Easter Carnival at Delungra was a big thing, for some even bigger than Christmas.

From early morning till the sun was gone it was all about slippery dips, merry-go-rounds, bucking horses, laughing clowns, giggling girls, fairy floss, and now and then of course, a few beers.

Back home for a visit, I drifted through the crowd, past the shooting gallery, the bar, a fortune teller, trick riders, rodeo clowns and charging bulls.

It was right then, I spied Caleb, my boy-hood friend and with a rush, those earlier days came flooding back.

From kindergarten we’d been all but inseparable as we played this and that game, often ignoring both lunch and dinner.

Caleb, though, was never one for sissy, girly games so it goes without saying the likes of marbles, hide-and-seek and hopscotch were out.

Those games were for wusses.

It was always war games, every one of them mired in death and destruction.

Caleb loved the battle and insisted, no matter how much pain was involved, on emerging victorious.

The Barbarians were our constant foe - and when not the Barbarians, it was the Apaches - and, when they too had been banished, it was the low-life Mexicans with their huge hats and cunning grins.

Then, when the war was over, we’d collapse down in the grass, dress up our wounds and smoke a Rothmans while planning the next carnage.

Our castle, walled high with rocks, was all but impregnable. As a warning to our enemies, upon a makeshift cross at the gates, we strung up roadkill, our best one ever a big black cat, just days before squashed flat by a huge Mack truck.

At other times it was a dead rabbit or a green frog. Dead cats, though, were the scariest.

Cal’s mum, both an animal lover and a committed Christian, and not at all happy with the way things were, promised ice cream and chocolate cake on the condition all crucifixions ceased that day.

It was about then, bit by bit, we began to mend our ways - but we dawdled, and so Cal’s mum, at the end of her tether, staged a coup, seizing all swords, guns, knives, and smokes; then, to ruin things entirely, declared Saturday a day of love and rest.

So that was it - no more Barbarians, Apaches or low-life Mexicans - our world now a sad, meaningless void.

In time, our castle walls, with years of wind and rain, collapsed, burying our flag, and the bones of three cats, two foxes and a goanna.

Till that Easter Saturday those days had been a distant memory; but spotting Caleb in the crowd, it seemed just yesterday.

Chapter 2

Honest Sam’s boxing troupe — Delungra’s tough boys – Insults — The Bear — Lessons in grammar.

HONEST SAM was a man of about fifty.

He was seriously overweight and smoked pretty well non-stop.

As a business man, he had a bit of a reputation. By ten that morning, dressed up in a red cardigan, black felt hat and bow tie, he was up on his stage doing his best to get things moving.

The sun was strong now and he was beginning to sweat as he kept repeating, “Right this minute we need three good men, three tough ones who know how to take care of themselves, who, just maybe, can show us how tough Delungra boys is.

“The big question is however: are Delungra boys really tough? Or are they what some people are saying these days - that they’re nothing but a lot of scared little mouses runnin’ and hidin.”

“It’s running and hiding, not runnin and hidin. And another thing, you should always say mice - not mouses.” came a voice from the crowd.

“Yea.— O.K. Good for you pal.”

Sam, pointing at his three fighters on the podium said, “It’s easy enough boys - it’s five bucks a round for three short rounds. And a full minute, that’s sixty long seconds boys, between rounds, so you can have a blow, catch your breath, and maybe, if you feel confident, stick a dollar on the out-come.

“It’s that easy. Just hang in there for three rounds - it’s the easiest few dollars you boys will ever come by. Think about it - fifteen bucks for nine measly little minutes and if you finish on top, it’s another twenty-five.

“It’s bloody charity! — Sheer bloody charity! Truth is, I’m just giving money away! People are saying I’m too kind, that I’m a saint - like that Sister Teresa woman in Pakistan.

“It’s fair to say these three bums up here (waving his finger at his fighters) aint all that hot - they’re a bloody lazy lot and eat, drink and smoke too much.

“To be honest, they’re a damned useless bunch. Some of you gents down there I have to admit look tough alright, I can see that. It’s been said Delungra boys are hard men, play footy on one leg and make love with broken necks and other things all crooked and messed up .. he...he...he.”

By now Sam was yelling so as to be heard over the drums of other spielers up and down the alley, “So, come on you lot - let’s see just how tough you boys is.”

“It’s you boys are - not you boys is.”

“And what’s Sister Teresa got to do with anything?”

“It’s Mother Teresa.”

“Anyhow, she aint in Pakistan - she’s in Ethiopia”

“What’s the difference? They’re all brown over there and look the same.”

“My mum says she’s a Kiwi.”

Sam took a bite of his burger, chewed hard for maybe five seconds then swallowed and said, “Look, let’s forget this Teresa woman. Just put her out of your little minds.”

He pointed to his tent. “It’s in there where the money is. Cash too, the folding stuff - so you won’t have to bother the tax man. I tell you gentlemen, it’s easy, a piece o’ cake - a bloody nice cake too.”

The boy with the drum, the skinny one in red shorts soon had his opponent, a big blonde lad, about fifteen. With a beer in his right hand he said, “I’ll have a go if it’s five bucks a round. Can’t hurt that much.”

Sam pulled the boy up onto the podium. The crowd clapped and cheered. A few whistles. Several boos. Sam took his hand and said, “O, K, kid, I gotta admit you look tough enough. Can you move quick? - cause your opponent there in red is a real smart mover - and he hits hard too.”

“I can hit too pop, don’t worry about that bit - ask the cops if you don’t believe me. They don’t like much what I done to Bluey Watson - neither does his mum. Serves him right but.”

“What’d you do sonny?”

“Dropped him cold I did - out cold - knocked a few teeth out too - he asked for it but - so he got it,” said the boy.

“And my Mum says we gunna fight any charges in court.”

Someone yelled, “The low bastard got him from behind he did - the low down, lying bastard.”

“Bullshit! I didn’t do nothin’ wrong! - twas a fair fight it was. He asked for it and I got him fair-n-square.”

“O.K. Kid - sounds promising,” Sam said. “You’ve made your point an’ it seems also you’ve got yourself a real supportive mum. So, what’s your name kid?”

“Jimmy — Jimmy Fleeton.”

“O.K. Jimmy, is your Mum here today to see how you go?”

“She’s aint here today - can’t make it - the judge said not for another month or so - depending on good behaviour and stuff like that.”

“Them judges are a mean lot kid.”

“Weak as piss, them judges is - someone should shoot the bastards - all of ’em.”

“Don’t shoot ’em all kid. Gotta have the odd judge. Otherwise, there’ll be nothin’ but anarchy.”

“What’s this anarchy stuff pop?”

“Don’t you worry about that anarchy stuff Jimmy.”

The operator, smiling away, draped his arm around Jimmy’s shoulders.

“O.K. Jimmy, you’re on - a definite starter,” he said, “and good luck, kid. In a short time now, we’ll know for sure just how good you really is.”

“It’s you really are - not you really is.” came that voice from the crowd.

“Listen, yu little smartarse, when I need some grammatical lessons on speech

therapy about abverbs, I’ll ask you.”

“It’s still you are, - not you is. And another thing, it’s not an adverb sir.”

“Get stuffed pal. And stick your stupid abverbs yu know where.”

Everyone, clapping and cheering, began calling out, “Forget the fight - more ab-verbs please!”

The promoter, not at all happy, turned and yelled out, “Forget them bloody abverbs! Let’s face it, right now, at this point in time, you Delungra boys ain’t lookin’ all that brave - in fact you’re lookin’ more and more gutless every second.

“You’ve got this name as tough boys, real tough ones. But I’m beginnin’ to think it’s a lotta frogshit. In my opinion you lot are a mob of low-life degenerates with all sorts of infections - and I aint talking warts or the common cold here neither.”

The crowd, not overly impressed, looked at one another, muttered a few words, then fell quiet. A second boy, one with blonde hair and freckles yelled out, “I’m nineteen, come from ‘round ‘ere and am about the same size as that bloke in the middle, - I’ll take him on - if he don’t mind blood.”

“That’s what I like! Confidence! A cocky one hey! Think yu can do it, do yu, kid?”

The blonde boy continued, “Don’t worry none about me Sam. I can do it, all right. I’ll finish him off in no time. I need the dough, yu see. I done some fightin’ up in Queensland - won too. An’ personally, I couldn’t give a stuff ‘bout them abverbs.”

The spruiker was smiling now. He said “O.K. kid - good for you! And glad you feel that way ‘bout them abverbs, - finish your drink and git up here kid.”

“Its adverbs - not abverbs don’t you ev... ..”

“Go home you mug! And take your stupid abverb book with you. This is a boxing tent, not a bloody university.”

“What’s a university?”

Someone yelled, “It’s where them perfesor people live. They’re a real smart lot with big I.Q’s — some as high as fifty - now and then even higher – so they know just about everything. Most times they sit around and think and use big words.”

“It’s professors, not as you say.....”

“Forget it pal.”

“Forget what?”

“More abverbs please!”

Sam helped the boy up, looked him up and down and smiled. He leaned over and told the boy in red shorts who was beating the drum to shut up while he engaged the new contender in conversation. The boy with the red shorts put the drum down and sulked.

Sam said, “Yu’ look tough enough kid - so what you need the dough for?

“For the girls, Mister - what else you need money for? Yu see pop, girls love a good time - and you need dough for that. Without a few bucks in our pockets us boys get nowhere. Queensland girls are cheaper but—a lot cheaper.”

...Continued next week.



Wellington Public School

AFL



Wellington PS took on Orana Heights in the PSSA AFL knockout. Players from each side displayed excellent sportsmanship, determination and teamwork throughout the match. While Wellington PS competed strongly and never gave up, it was Orana Heights who came away as deserving winners on the day. Congratulations to both teams for the positive way they represented their schools and the game of AFL.



Our girls AFL team travelled to Bathurst to compete in the Paul Kelly Cup Regional Finals, and what a day they had!

The girls were outstanding from start to finish, winning all three pool matches to book their place in the Grand Final. Unfortunately, in a game where every moment mattered, the bounce of the ball (quite literally!) didn't go our way, with St Mary's Dubbo edging us out in a hard-fought decider.

A huge congratulations to all of the girls on a fantastic achievement, and to super coach Mr Bullock for guiding the team through an exceptional campaign.

Results:

WPS 15 def St Mary's Dubbo 12

WPS 58 def Assumption Bathurst 2

WPS 8 def Forbes PS 2

Grand Final:

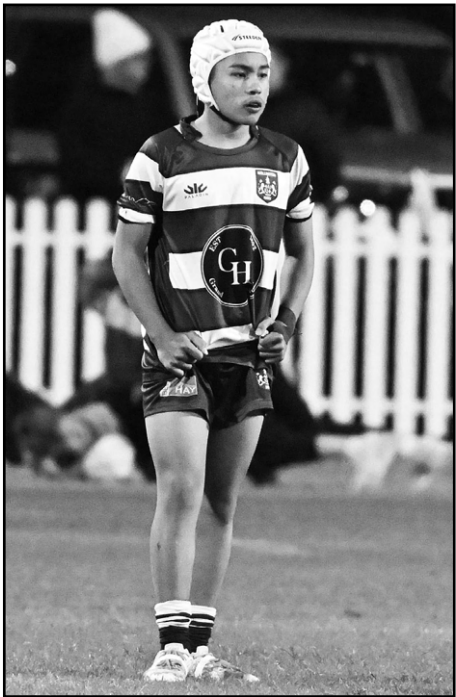
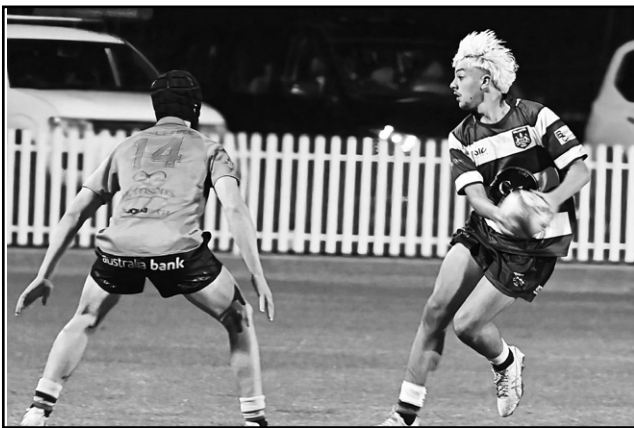
St Mary's Dubbo 12 def WPS 9

We couldn't be prouder of the way the girls represented our school. Well done, girls!



Redback Juniors

Carmen Gain photos



Golfing News

Big day Sunday to top off a big week

EACH DAY was filled with golfing last week culminating on Sunday with the Diggers and Dubbo RSL Stableford.

This followed a big day on Saturday starting with Round one of the Joe Ryan Mowing Winter Cup red tee day, plus the Soldiers Club July Monthly Medal, George Hollow Putting Competition and the Final of the Kiss Trophy.

Congratulations to Josh Bullock who is taking on the managers role of the Western Primary Schools golf team. He also organised and helped in the running of the Junior Western Golf tournament at Wellington which was a selection try-out.

Congratulations to the ladies who ventured to Dubbo to play in the Open; although there were no winners, by all reports a great day was had by all.

Kiss Trophy Final see's Gary Cusack taking on John Gersbach in a match that should be a close affair, my tip is John, so Gary's a certainty.

Saturdays Red Tee winner in A grade was Kurt Cusack who thought driving the greens was easy, final score 70nett. Runner-up was Tim Parker on a countback with 71nett, good to see you haven't lost it Tim.

Red Tee winner in B grade was Damien Bell who saw less trees off these tee's, final score 70nett. Runner-up was Peter Neuenhaus who finished with a 71nett.

Prize winners were Kosta Athanasiou 71nett; Scott Hull, Steven McCarroll, Rob Parnell, Stephen Whiteman, Reid Armstrong 72netts; Elton Keeffe, John Donnelly, Jono Smith 73netts; John Gersbach 74nett on c/b.

Nearest the pin on 3rd John Donnelly, 8th Steven McCarroll, 14th Lewis Stanley, 16th Reid Armstrong.

NTP in two shots on the 17th went to Jono Smith.

Longest drives went to David East in A grade and Peter



Noella Baker, Denise Haesler, Patsie O'Brien, Wendy Slack-Smith and Marie Cornish at the Dubbo Open.

Holden in B grade.

The Brent Eather Encouragement award was awarded but I've been paid off to not disclose the identity of this golfer.

Wednesday's Individual Stableford and Round of the Cornish-Hollow Trophy.

Winner was Noella Baker who was the only golfer to at least play to their handicap, her final score was 36pts. Runner-up was Wendy Slack-Smith on c/b with 34pts.

Prize winners were Kathy Martin 34pts, Cheryl Royal 33pts.

Cornish-Hollow Trophy round winners were Noella Baker and Wendy Slack-Smith with a combined 70pts.

Thursday's Individual Stableford winner was Ashley Bullock who compiled a massive 40pts. Runner-up with 37pts was Nathan Stewart. Prize winners were Drew Stone 33pts, Rod McMahon 31pts.

Sunday's Diggers - Dubbo RSL Individual Stableford golf day gained a big golfing crew with Diggers' Sarah Darney claiming the prize with a massive 52pts. Runner-up was Garry McNaughton who put together a good round to finish with 42pts. Dubbo RSL results saw Garry McNaughton also claimed the Dubbo RSL winner's prize with Brad Hyland claiming the runners up prize.

NTP's on 3rd Mark Andrews, Brad Hyland, 14th Robert Hargraves, James McGrath.

Round 1 of the Lion of Waterloo Trophy is to be played by July 11.

19th Hole

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BINGO WITH A TRIVIA
TWIST

FREE

Wellington Soldiers
Memorial Club
Thursday 9th July
11 am

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial Club

END OF MONTH
RAFFLE PRIZES

1. \$1000 VOUCHER TO BENS TYRES
2. \$1000 VOUCHER TO HARVEY NORMAN
3. \$300 CUSACK'S BUTCHERY
4. \$100 HARDWARE HOME & RURAL
5. \$300 CENTRAL BUTCHERY
6. QUARTER HIND OF BEEF VALUE \$100
7. \$400 VOUCHER TO WOOLWORTHS
8. \$300 VOUCHER TO WELLINGTON SOLDIERS CLUB
10. \$400 VOUCHER TO COLES
11. \$400 VOUCHER TO WELLINGTON SOLDIERS CLUB

MEMBERS BADGE DRAW
TUESDAY'S
FRIDAY'S
SUNDAY'S

The prize bank is growing! Don't miss out!
You must be at the Club to Win!

CASH FEVER
FRIDAY'S
SUNDAY'S

DRAWN AFTER THE RAFFLES

★ COUNTRY MUSIC ★
— darling —
CLANCY PYE
— at the club —
SATURDAY 4TH JULY
★ 7:30PM ★

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial Club

LIVE COUNTRY MUSIC

JUSTIN
Landers

7:30PM

SINGING COUNTRY GREATS AND HIS ORIGINALS

SATURDAY
JULY
25TH